



Android Apps Made Easy with Processing

Any computer enthusiast would love to create an Android app, a seemingly difficult task. But combine Android with Processing and it is easy. Here's a simple demonstration on how to use Android in tandem with Processing to create apps.

Android application development has become the coolest thing in the cyber world, for geeks and developers, and there is a great demand for them. Tutorials on Android app development with Eclipse can become frustrating at times. But as always, with the open source world, there is always an alternative way that works just out-of-the-box.

Android is a Linux-based operating system for mobile devices such as smartphones and tablet computers. It has been developed by the Open Handset Alliance, led by Google, and other companies. The initial developer of the software, Android Inc., was bought over by Google in 2005. The Android distribution was launched in 2007, and the Open Handset Alliance was founded. This is a consortium of 86 hardware, software and telecommunications companies devoted to advancing open standards for mobile devices. Google releases the Android code as open source, under the Apache License. The Android Open Source Project (AOSP) is tasked with the maintenance and further development of Android.

About Processing

Processing is an open source programming language and integrated development environment (IDE) built for the electronic arts and visual design communities with the purpose of teaching the basics of computer programming in a visual context, and to serve as the foundation for electronic sketchbooks. The project was initiated in 2001 by Casey Reas and Benjamin Fry. It brings complex graphics programming down to earth for the common man. For more, visit <http://www.processing.org>

Before starting this tutorial I would like readers to get acquainted with Processing and its code, which is Java, and learn to write basic programs with it.

So combining Processing with Android can make the open source world livelier. Let's look at how to develop Android apps using Processing and package them as `.apk` files.

Prerequisites

- For this article I have used Processing 2.1 on Ubuntu 13.10. Processing can be downloaded from <http://www>.